for Brigadier to Major General also happens during the Army Commanders' Conference and our SB had already been held earlier that year, in the April conference. The result of the promotion board was declared in early October, in which I was cleared for promotion to Major General in both the Command and Staff streams. Since the NDC course is meant only for Brigadiers, my name was deleted from the agenda and I never got the benefit of attending the NDC. I am thus probably the first non-NDC Chief. I was told that I would be side-stepped within the AWC or within Mhow to pick up my rank but that did not materialize. Instead, I was posted in mid-December, as the Chief of Staff to 33 Corps at Sukna, which looks after Sikkim. I thus stayed in Mhow for only eleven months and had to leave HC 41 midway. One way to look at it was that I had 'done' one full course, the last four months of HC 40 and the first six months of HC 41. Time to pack again!

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